Incident report: ledger reconciliation mismatch

Document: INC-402

Date: 2026-04-16

Services: ledger

Summary

SEV3: On April 15, 2026, the daily reconciliation process detected a mismatch between ledger entries and the NorthBank settlement file. The Ledger team identified that 312 ledger entries were recorded on the wrong date due to a timezone handling error introduced in CHG-1072. The settlement import was reading timestamps in UTC+2 as UTC, causing late-evening transactions to shift to the following calendar day. CHG-1074 corrected the affected entries and fixed the import logic.

Impact

The reconciliation mismatch affected 312 ledger entries, creating a discrepancy between Acme's internal ledger and NorthBank's settlement records. This prevented the daily reconciliation from completing successfully and raised concerns about data integrity. No merchant-facing services were disrupted, and no payments were lost or duplicated. The issue was contained to historical record accuracy.

Timeline

- 02:00 UTC: Daily reconciliation process ran and detected mismatched entries

- Investigation began by Sara Haddad to identify the source of the discrepancy

- Root cause traced to CHG-1072 and its timezone handling

- CHG-1074 deployed to correct the import logic and fix affected entries

Root Cause

CHG-1072 introduced a new NorthBank settlement file import process. The import code was reading timestamps in UTC+2 as UTC, causing a two-hour offset. Transactions that occurred in the evening UTC+2 time were recorded in the ledger on the following UTC day, creating a mismatch with NorthBank's settlement file which used correct timezone conversion.

Resolution

CHG-1074 was deployed to fix the settlement import timezone handling. The 312 affected ledger entries were corrected to reflect the proper transaction dates. The reconciliation process was re-run and completed successfully.

Follow-up Actions

Review RB-04 for standard reconciliation mismatch procedures. Implement timezone validation in settlement file imports to prevent similar issues. Consider adding automated timezone checks to the deployment pipeline for changes affecting financial data processing.